Mary Cris Tapic | Operations & financial administration · Case study

The filing was simple. That was the problem.

Matching incoming receipts, invoices and payments to the right job is not difficult work. It is just constant. I built a workflow that filed each record, logged it, calculated the totals, and asked me only about the records it could not read with confidence.

My role
Designed, built, documented, operated

Built with
Google Drive, OCR, Apps Script, Sheets

Period
Built and operated 2024–2026

What it was like before

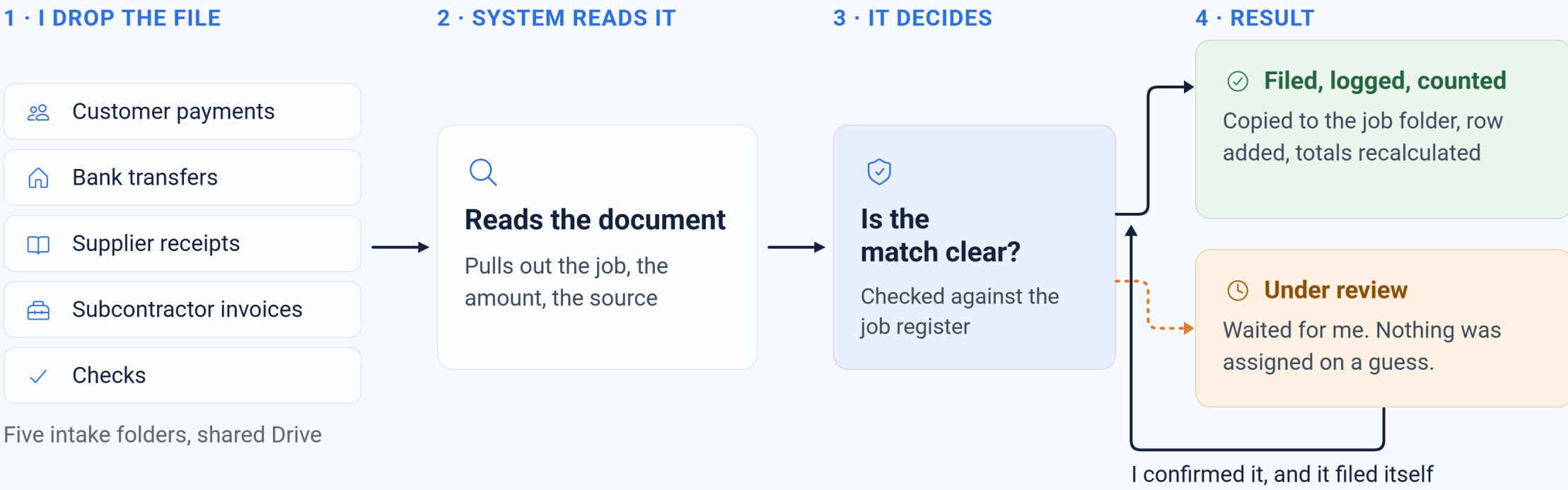
A business owner I supported received financial records constantly, from every direction: supplier receipts, subcontractor invoices, bank transfers, check images, customer payments. Each one had to be identified, filed under the right job, recorded on a cost sheet, and kept for later reference. On an active job, around a hundred of these could be waiting at once, and every one was opened, read and matched by hand.

None of that is complicated. All of it repeats every week, for as long as the business runs. Three things made it cost more than it should have:

- A receipt does not always say which job it belongs to. Working that out meant opening it, reading it, and often checking something else.
- Documents lived in one place and the numbers lived in another, so a cost figure could not be traced back to the paper behind it without a search.
- Because it was manual, it was skippable. Anything postponed became a backlog, and backlogs are where errors hide.

What I built

A single intake path. I dropped a file into one of five intake folders in the shared Drive. Everything after that happened without me, unless the system was unsure.



The only recurring manual step was dropping the file in. The only recurring decision was the one the system could not make honestly.

Where the record ends up

Each job has a cost summary. Every line on it is backed by a sub-sheet that breaks the figure down, and every entry carries a link straight to the receipt, invoice or check it came from.

Nothing in the summary is typed in. I set the logic once: how categories roll up, how overhead and profit percentages apply, how confirmed payments net against the total, and how every figure recalculates from the logged rows as records arrive. Arithmetic and re-keying are where errors used to enter. My job was to check that the inputs and logic were right, not to add things up.

One tab per cost line, whether it is a professional service, a subcontractor or a material supplier. Every figure is a formula reading from the tab behind it, including the percentage rows and the outstanding balance. The two unused overhead rows stay in the template because different jobs carry different structures.

Lot Improvement Project — cost summary (every figure is a formula)

Category	Professional Services	Materials	Total Expense
Municipal Permits	$480.00		
Structural Engineering	$24,150.00		
Environmental Inspection	$920.00		
Site Surveying	$275.00		
Landscape Design	$1,875.00		
Paving Subcontractor	$8,900.00		
Electrical Subcontractor	$3,400.00		
Aggregate and Base Material		$6,400.00	
Concrete Supply		$9,850.00	
Fencing Materials		$2,310.00	
Total Expenses	$40,000.00	$18,560.00	$58,560.00
Contractor Overhead @ 10%			$5,856.00
Administrative Overhead @ 2%			$1,171.20
Contractor Overhead @ 13.75% (unused)			
Contractor Profit @ 10% (unused)			
Grand Total Cost			$65,587.20
Client Payments Received			$27,400.00
Outstanding Balance Prior to Final Reconciliation			$38,187.20

The boxed total at the top is the only figure that leaves this tab.

It is the sum of the invoice rows below it, and it is what the Paving Subcontractor line on the summary is reading. Subcontractor tabs also carry a payment status, so an unpaid invoice stays visible on the line it belongs to.

Paving Subcontractor — the $8,900.00 line, broken out

Date	Payment to	Amount	Status	Links
	Total invoiced →	$8,900.00		
7-31-25	Invoice #04-58443	$3,560.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…
8-31-25	Invoice #04-58546	$2,670.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…
9-30-25	Invoice #04-58634	$2,670.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…

Receivables use the same structure as payables.

The boxed total is what the summary subtracts, so the outstanding balance is the difference between two evidenced totals rather than an estimate.

Client Payments — money coming in

Date	Job Name	Total Amount Paid	Invoice Links	Check Links
	Total received →	$27,400.00		
9/6/2024	Lot Improvement	$8,200.00	drive.google.com/…	drive.google.com/…
7/21/2025	Lot Improvement	$6,700.00	drive.google.com/…	drive.google.com/…
9/30/2025	Lot Improvement	$12,500.00	drive.google.com/…	drive.google.com/…

Material tabs work the same way.

Delivery tickets and supplier receipts land here, and the boxed total feeds the Materials column on the summary.

Concrete Supply — the $9,850.00 material line, broken out

Date	Payment to	Amount	Status	Links
	Total invoiced →	$9,850.00		
6-15-25	Delivery ticket #22118	$4,200.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…
7-02-25	Delivery ticket #22461	$3,150.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…
8-19-25	Delivery ticket #22903	$2,500.00	Paid	drive.google.com/…

This is the queue that matters.

The unreadable check scan and the transfer covering two jobs were held here rather than filed somewhere plausible. Neither reached a total until I cleared it, so no balance counted money that had not been tied to evidence. All names and figures on these sheets are invented.

Intake log — what the system did with each incoming file

Received	File	Matched to	Amount	Status
5/11	ticket_22903.pdf	Concrete Supply	$2,500.00	Matched
5/11	inv_04-58634.pdf	Paving Subcontractor	$2,670.00	Matched
5/12	check_scan_09.jpg	—	$1,250.00	Under review
5/12	permit_city.pdf	Municipal Permits	$480.00	Matched
5/13	transfer_0513.pdf	two jobs	$3,900.00	Under review

The rule I built in on purpose

An automated matcher can be tuned to always produce an answer. I did not build it that way.

When the reference is ambiguous, the scan is poor, or one payment covers several jobs, the record goes to review instead of to a job. A wrong match that looks settled is worse than an open question, because nobody goes looking for it.

That single choice is what makes the numbers usable. A total is only as good as the evidence sitting behind it, and every figure in this system can be opened and checked.

What changed

627+ files processed through the intake workflow

- Filing, copying and logging happened on their own. The recurring work that used to fill the day no longer needed a person.
- What was left was reviewing the flagged items, which took minutes and depended only on how many came in.
- Totals, overhead and outstanding balances calculated themselves from the logged records, so no figure was re-keyed by hand.
- Every cost figure opened to the document behind it, so questions got answered instead of researched.
- Nothing depended on remembering. If a record had not been handled, it sat in review where it could be seen.

Where this applies

The industry does not matter much. Any business that receives documents tied to something — a job, a client, a property, a course, a contract — and has to keep the money straight against them has this same problem. The parts that carry across are a single intake path, a register the matching is checked against, a link from every figure to its source, a calculation layer that keeps totals current without anyone adding them up, and a review queue that catches whatever the system cannot answer for itself.

All names and figures in this case study are illustrative. No client, vendor, banking or project information is shown.

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